

Personal Reflection

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The most challenging aspects of this portfolio project for me have been defining my goals and vouching for myself as a personal brand. This project has forced me to really where I'm at in my life and who I am as a person. After learning about all these different frameworks for understanding communication and personal and cultural and identity and I feel like I have a much better grasp of how I can define my own identity and use that to achieve my goals. The 4th module talks a lot about Identity as a performance (Newsom & Montenegro, 2025). Burke's Pentad breaks up this idea of complex idea of identifying into five aspects, the act, the agent, the agency, the scene, and the purpose (Newsom & Montenegro, 2025, Section 4.2). I think this last aspect of purpose is especially essential for me to recognize when creating the portfolio. With that in mind my intent with this portfolio is to ground every decision with a central goal for what I want my identity to achieve. This goal has been hard for me to pin down because I feel unsure about my future and I have changed a lot as a person since I started college and my goals have change with that. Despite this uncertainty, I think defining my goals today, even if I'm unsure of them, is valuable not only for this project but for my life in general. With all that said, my main goal today is to study applied math and eventual transfer to a four-year school and build connections with others that share my interest in math and STEM. I want to be able to send this portfolio to someone and for them to get a good idea of who and am as a person and how I use what I have learned from my field of study. I will focus on my interest in math and academics while also presenting my personal identity and interests outside of academics to paint a picture of who I am as a person today.

Especially for my age, I have a very minimal digital footprint. I don't haven't used social media in years so when you look up my name basically nothing relating to me comes up. This, I think, is a double-edged sword. While I have a clean slate to build my digital identity on, I also have less credibility and not much of a public voice. This portfolio gives me the opportunity to shape my digital footprint and identity into something that helps me achieve my goals and lets people know who I am. This is part of the reason why I feel like it's important to include my interests outside a purely academic setting. By including part of my personal identity, I can add credibility to my digital identity as well as keep the portfolio engaging for those who see it.

References

Newsom, V., & Montenegro, D. A. (2025). Communication Literacy: An Introduction to Communications Studies (1st ed., pp. 1–335) [Review of Communication Literacy: An Introduction to Communications Studies]. LibreTexts.